

Tug of War

There was a rabbit who enjoyed playing **tricks** on other animals. One day he was walking in the **woods** near the sea, he **came across** a huge elephant pulling out and eating leaves from a tree.

"How are you, Mr Elephant?" he **called out**. My, how much you eat!

"That's because I'm so big, replied the elephant." Small animals like you don't need much food, but large and powerful animals like me need a lot!

"Large you **certainly** are said the rabbit, but powerful...?"

"You don't think I'm powerful?" asked the elephant, **sounding** surprised, and also a little **annoyed**.

"I'm sure you are," said the rabbit. "But are you more powerful than me?"

The elephant thought he had not heard right

"Powerful? You?"

"Yes, me."

The elephant **doubled up** with laughter.

"You're laughing because you don't know how strong I am," said the rabbit. "If you let me tie a rope around your middle, I'll **drag** you into the sea."

"Drag me into the sea?!" laughed the elephant. "Hoo-hooo hoooo! Weil, go ahead! Tie a rope around me and let me see how far you can pull me!"

The rabbit tied a thick rope around the elephant's body.

"When you feel a **tug** on the rope, be ready to pull", he said, or you'll be dragged into the sea before you know what's happening!"

"Please don't pull too hard," **mocked** the elephant.

The rabbit ran to the **seashore** with the other end of the rope.

He saw a whale swimming some distance away, and called out to it. When the whale drew near he said, "Mr Whale you're so big but are you strong?"

"I'm the strongest animal on Earth!" **bellowed** the whale.



"I'll show you how wrong you are," said the rabbit. "Let me tie this rope around your middle.

"And then?"

"I'll drag you **ashore**."

The whale doubled up with laughter.

"All right, go ahead," he **giggled**. "Tie your rope around me and pull me out

The rabbit tied the rope securely around the whale's middle. Then he ran ashore and rushing into the woods, hid behind a tree and shouted, "PULL!"



The elephant, **intending** to throw the rabbit high into the sky to **frighten** him, **wrapped** his trunk around the rope and gave a **mighty heave** upwards. The whale **countered** with a tug that almost **brought the elephant to his knees**. The two animals, hidden from each other's **sight** by the trees in between, **marvelled** at the strength of the rabbit. They pulled and heaved and **exerted** their strength **to the utmost**, but neither could get the better of the other. Finally the rope broke and the two animals fled in opposite directions.

From then on whenever the elephant saw the rabbit he would quickly hide himself or run away, to the great **amusement** of the rabbit.

Vocabulary

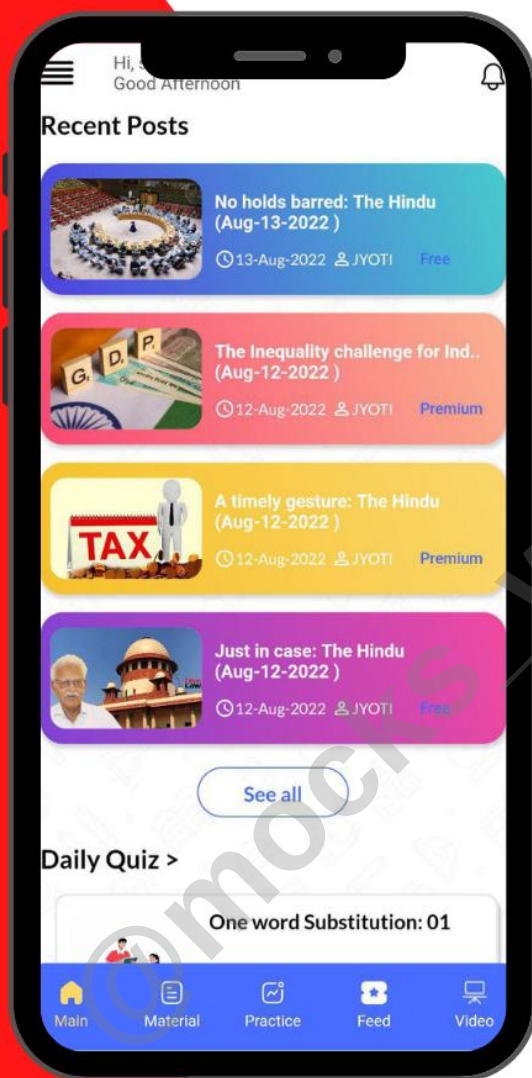
1. **Trick** (noun) – prank, deception, mischief, ruse, hoax चालाकी
2. **The woods** (noun) – forest, jungle, grove, woodland, thicket जंगल
3. **Come across** (phrasal verb) – encounter, discover, stumble upon, run into, find अचानक मिलना
4. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – shout, yell, exclaim, cry, announce आवाज़ देना
5. **Certainly** (adverb) – surely, definitely, indeed, undoubtedly, truly निश्चित रूप से
6. **Sound** (verb) – seem, appear, resonate, echo, indicate लगना / प्रतीत होना
7. **Annoyed** (adjective) – irritated, upset, bothered, displeased, disturbed चिढ़ा हुआ
8. **Double up** (phrasal verb) – bend over, crouch, hunch, fold, collapse हँसी के मारे झुक जाना
9. **Drag** (verb) – pull, haul, tug, tow, yank खींचना
10. **Tug** (noun) – pull, jerk, yank, wrench, heave खींचाव / झटका
11. **Mock** (verb) – tease, ridicule, taunt, mimic, make fun of मज़ाक उड़ाना
12. **Seashore** (noun) – coast, beach, shoreline, waterfront, strand समुद्र तट
13. **Bellow** (verb) – roar, shout, yell, holler, cry out गर्जना करना
14. **Ashore** (noun) – land, coast, beach, bank, shore किनारे पर
15. **Giggle** (verb) – chuckle, snicker, titter, laugh, snigger दबी-दबी हँसी हँसना
16. **Intend** (verb) – plan, aim, propose, mean, design इरादा रखना
17. **Frighten** (verb) – scare, terrify, startle, alarm, petrify डराना
18. **Wrap** (verb) – enclose, bind, coil, cover, fold लपेटना
19. **Mighty** (adjective) – powerful, strong, forceful, robust, formidable बलशाली
20. **Heave** (noun) – pull, lift, haul, yank, drag जोरदार खींचाव
21. **Counter** (verb) – oppose, resist, retaliate, respond, defy प्रतिरोध करना
22. **Bring someone to one's knees** (phrase) – overpower, defeat, humble, subdue, crush घुटनों पर ला देना
23. **Sight** (noun) – view, vision, scene, spectacle, appearance दृष्टि / नज़ारा
24. **Marvel** (verb) – wonder, admire, gaze, be amazed, be astonished आश्चर्य करना

25. **Exert** (verb) – apply, use, exercise, employ,
strain प्रयास करना

27. **Amusement** (noun) – fun, entertainment,
enjoyment, delight, laughter मनोरंजन

26. **To the utmost** (phrase) – completely, fully,
totally, to the limit, with maximum effort
अधिकतम सीमा तक

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